



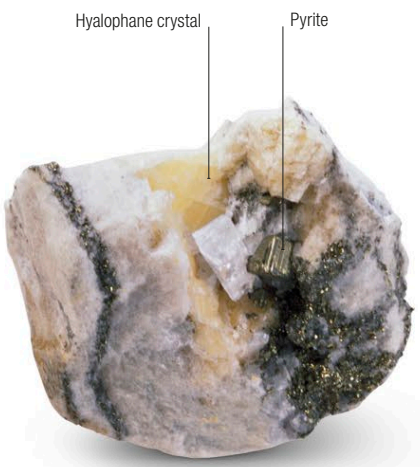
Marble

△ **Breccia marble**, shattered and re-cemented

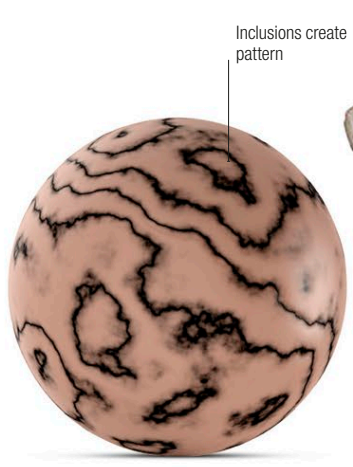
A **granular rock derived from** limestone or dolomite, marble consists of a mass of interlocking calcite or dolomite grains. Pure marble is white. Other types take their common names from their colour or mineral impurities. These impurities tend to occur as layers of other minerals thinly interbedded in the original limestone, so may be present as bands or swirls. Other veined and patterned marbles are created when an existing example is cracked or shattered, and the spaces between the fragments fill in with calcite or other minerals.

Specification

Rock type	Regional or contact metamorphic	Temperature	High
Pressure	Low to high	Structure	Crystalline
Major minerals	Calcite	Minor minerals	Diopside, tremolite, actinolite
Colour	White, pink	Texture	Fine to coarse
Protolith	Limestone, dolomite		



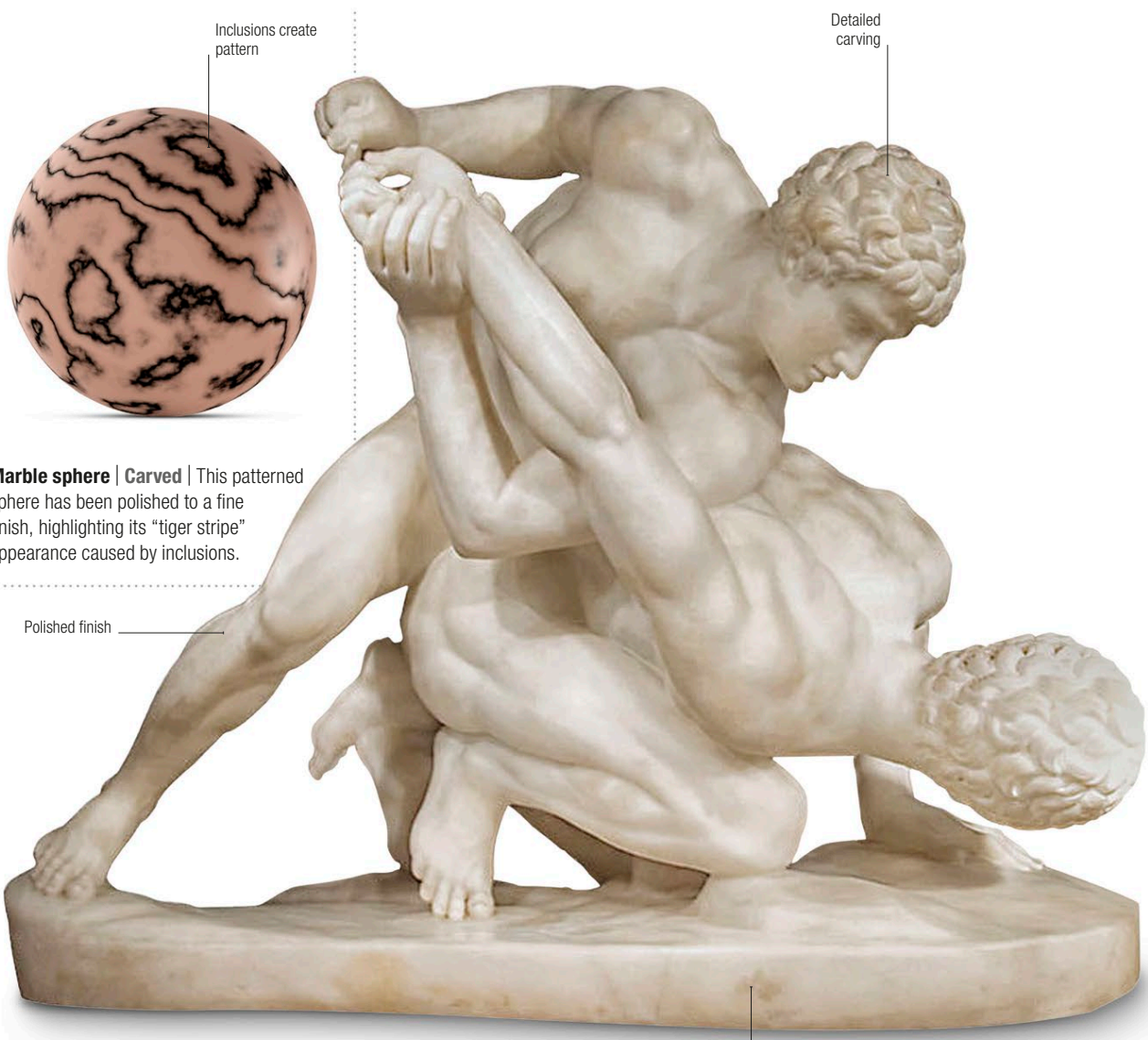
Marble specimen | Rough | This specimen consists of minerals – hyalophane crystal and pyrite – enclosed within dolomitic marble.



Marble sphere | Carved | This patterned sphere has been polished to a fine finish, highlighting its “tiger stripe” appearance caused by inclusions.



Marble sculpture | Carved | The flowing lines of this sculpture cut from marble are emphasized by the simplicity of the carving. It has fine white colouring.



Marble statue | Carved | This early 19th-century Italian, large-scale, translucent marble statue depicts wrestlers raised on a rock-shaped base. Fine craftsmanship and a smoothly rendered finish emphasize the translucence of the material. The piece was inspired by an ancient Roman bronze.

Raised base anchors figures